

Cover note

Email template — personalize before sending

Working draft v0.2 · June 21, 2026

► Before sending: personalize the bracketed lines — above all the opening, which should say, specifically and honestly, why this person. Drop in your contact, then delete this instruction line. Keep it short; this goes in the body of your email, with the one-pager and Declaration attached or linked.

Subject: An invitation — building an internet owned by its users (July 2)

Dear [Name],

[One or two sentences, personal and specific: why you are writing to *them*. Name the work of theirs that connects to this — a project, a stance, a thing they built or argued for. This is the line that earns a reply, so make it genuine rather than flattering.]

I'm part of a small group preparing to mark July 2 — the 250th anniversary of the vote for American independence — by publishing a **Declaration of Internet Independence**: a statement that the internet should belong to the people who use it, and that we intend to build it. The internet today hands a handful of owners the value that billions of us create, and AI is about to compound that advantage in the very same hands. The terms of the next era of the internet are being set right now. We think they can be set deliberately, for people — rather than by default, to them.

The real work comes after the declaration: writing the **constitution of a user-owned internet, in public**. We're inviting a small number of framers to help lead it, and I'd be honored if you were one of them. It's a founding role rather than an advisory title — the commitment is real but bounded, and for now I'm only asking for a conversation.

I've attached a one-page overview and the draft Declaration; there's a fuller brief and several short essays if you'd like to go deeper. Could we find twenty minutes in the next couple of weeks?

With respect and real hope,

[Your name]

[your contact]